

Paid Time Off and Leave

Document owner: People Operations • Last updated: 2026-01-08 • Supersedes: rev 4 (2025-06-11)

Leave at Nordvane is generous by intention and unremarkable by design. The company does not operate an unlimited leave policy, having concluded that unlimited policies reliably reduce the amount of leave people actually take, and instead sets a fixed allowance high enough that most employees do not exhaust it. Managers are measured informally on whether their reports take their leave, and a team in which several people are carrying large balances into the following year is treated as a management issue rather than as dedication.

Annual leave

Leave type	Entitlement	Paid	Notice	Notes
Annual leave	30 days per calendar year	Full pay	See below	In addition to local public holidays
Sick leave	Uncapped	Full pay	Same day	Doctor's note only where local law requires
Parental leave, primary carer	6 months	Full pay	As early as practical	Eligibility after 6 months of employment
Parental leave, secondary carer	6 weeks	Full pay	As early as practical	Eligibility after 6 months of employment
Compassionate leave	Up to 5 days	Full pay	None	Manager discretion, not tracked
Unpaid leave	By negotiation	Unpaid	60 days	Agreed individually with People Operations

Table 1. Leave entitlements for full-time employees. Contractors are covered by their individual agreements.

Annual leave accrues monthly but may be taken in advance of accrual with manager approval, which is granted as a matter of course and is refused only where someone is in their notice period. Up to 10 unused days may be carried into the following year and must be used before 31 March; days beyond that are forfeited. Nordvane does not pay out unused leave except where local law requires it on termination, and employees in countries where payout is mandatory are notified of this by people operations at the point of resignation rather than being expected to know it.

Requesting leave

Requests are made in the people tool and approved by the direct manager. There is no minimum notice period for one or two days, and requests of that length are approved automatically unless the manager actively objects within 24 hours. Absences longer than five working days should be requested at least three weeks ahead so that on-call rotations can be adjusted, and two people from the same rotation may not be on leave simultaneously unless the rotation has been rebalanced first. The rotation constraint is the only hard blocker in the approval flow; everything else is a conversation.

Sickness

Sick leave is not counted against annual leave and is not capped. Employees are asked to notify their manager and, where they are on the current rotation, to post in the on-call channel so that the secondary can take over without anyone needing to work out what happened. A doctor's note is requested only where local law requires one, which is typically after the fifth consecutive day. Nobody at Nordvane is expected to work while ill, and the practice of working through minor illness because the alternative feels like an imposition on colleagues is

explicitly discouraged.

Parental leave

Parental leave is six months at full pay for the primary carer and six weeks at full pay for the secondary carer. It is available to all employees regardless of gender and regardless of whether the child arrived by birth, adoption, or surrogacy. It may be taken in up to three separate blocks within 18 months of the child's arrival, an arrangement introduced in 2024 after several employees pointed out that a single continuous block suits some families and not others. Eligibility begins after six months of employment. Where local statutory entitlement exceeds the Nordvane policy, the statutory entitlement applies and the company tops up pay to full salary where the statutory scheme does not.